Superintendent's Report

School District No. 1J, Multnomah County, Oregon
Regular Board Meeting of December 13, 2004
AGENDA

1. Announcements/Celebrations
2. Name Change for Vocational Village High School
3. Classified Employee Recognition
4. Financial Accountability: Presentation of Annual Audit; First Reading of Policies
5. Academic Accountability: Student Achievement Committee's New Website; Recognition of Schools Achieving "Exceptional" Status on State Report Cards; Recognition of Schools that Improved Status on State Report Cards; and Review of State Report Card Results
6. Report from Multnomah Education Service District (MESD)
7. Student Representative's Report
8. Business Agenda
9. Other Business
10. Remaining Citizen Comment
11. Adjourn

INFORMAL MINUTES
Regular Board Meeting, December 13, 2004

The regular meeting of the Board of Directors came to order at 6:33 PM on the above date at the call of Co-Chair Julia Brim-Edwards in the Auditorium of the Blanchard Education Service Center, 501 North Dixon Street, Portland, Oregon.

There were present:

Board of Directors:
Julia Brim-Edwards, Co-Chair
Lolenzo Poe, Co-Chair
Derry A. Jackson, Sr.
Douglas Morgan
Bobbie Regan -- *absent*
Dilafruz Williams -- *absent*
David Wynde*t*

Student Representative:
Suleima Cortez

Staff:
Vicki L. Phillips, Superintendent
Jollee Faber Patterson, General Counsel/Board Secretary
Julie Joel, Executive Assistant, Board of Education

1. ANNOUNCEMENTS/CELEBRATIONS

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards explained the agenda for the evening and noted that Directors Regan and Williams were out of town and thus unable to attend the meeting.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards announced the January 24, 2005 School Board meeting will be held at Hosford Middle School, and she thanked Principal Melissa Sandven and staff for hosting the Board that evening.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards announced a change in Board committee assignments – Student Representative Suleima Cortez requested membership on the Community and Staff Relations Committee. Ms. Cortez indicated her school schedule did not allow her to attend Student Achievement Committee meetings.

Celebrate! Portland Public Schools

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards announced the Celebrate! Portland Public Schools event will be held on January 18th at the Memorial Coliseum from 5:30-8:30 PM. Parking will be free, and she added there will be a special focus for families on kindergarten programs.

PPS Employees Recognized at 10th Annual Oregon Peacemakers Conference

Student Representative Suleima Cortez announced that on November 9th two PPS employees, Suzanne Toole and Anibal Rivera, were honored at the 10th Annual Oregon Peacemakers Conference. Mr. Rivera is an Integration Specialist at Franklin High School, and he accepted an award on behalf of Franklin's long-standing peer mediation program. Ms. Cortez indicated Ms. Toole is a counselor at Mt. Tabor Middle School and was recognized for her work in implementing the school's four-star student peer mediation program. Ms. Cortez noted that Oregon Peacemakers Conference is sponsored by Resolutions Northwest with support from other communication organizations. It is a conference for middle and high school students to learn practical information and skills about nonviolence and peacemaking which can be implemented and shared in their schools and communities.

Co-Chairs Brim-Edwards and Poe, along with Superintendent Phillips, presented certificates to Ms. Toole and Mr. Rivera.

Recognition of Lighthouse Award Winners

Director Morgan announced two PPS employees from the Research, Evaluation and Assessment Department, Tiel Jackson and Karin Fallon, were announced as winners of the November Oregon Department of Education's Lighthouse Award. He stated they worked tirelessly over the past four months with ODE staff to highlight anomalies in the various assessment and Adequate Yearly Progress data files posted to the student staging site. They were able to highlight programming and other errors that affected data from many districts throughout the state.

Co-Chairs Brim-Edwards and Poe, along with Superintendent Phillips, presented certificates to Ms. Jackson and Ms. Fallon.

Gregory Heights Penny Drive

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards said she attended the annual Gregory Heights Penny Drive, which is a competition between classes and a way to raise funds to donate to different groups and individuals selected by the students. She said Principal Bonnie Hobson invited her to attend the student assembly where the penny drive results were announced – how much was raised and which class raised the most money. Co-Chair Brim-Edwards stated last year students provided more than $3,000 to the families of service members in Iraq. This year the students raised more than $4,000 and again raised the money for families of members of the service. She noted that former Gregory Heights student Sam Lightner was presented with a $1,000 scholarship.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards thanked the Gregory Heights students for their generosity and kindness and said it was a wonderful example of students, many with few financial resources, generously giving back to the community.

Replays

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards announced the replays of the December 13, 2004 meeting can be viewed on Channel 28 on:

Wednesday, Dec. 15, 2004	9:30 PM
Friday, Dec. 17, 2004	10:00 AM and 8:30 PM
Saturday, Dec. 18, 2004	7:30 PM
Sunday, Dec. 19, 2004	4:00 PM
Monday, Dec. 20, 2004	8:00 AM

2. **NAME CHANGE FOR VOCATIONAL VILLAGE HIGH SCHOOL**

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards noted that last year the Board decided the Glenhaven building was no longer a safe and adequate facility to serve as the home of Vocational Village High School. She added the land and building were sold to Banfield Pet Hospital, and they are now building a new headquarters on the site, which has had a positive impact on the neighborhood.

Director Morgan, a member of the Community and Staff Relations Committee, reviewed Resolution #3176, which recommended the name of Vocational Village High School be changed to Joseph L. Meek Professional Technical High School. He stated the committee examined the request and unanimously recommended the name change via resolution to the full Board.

A.J. Morrison, Principal of Vocational Village High School, discussed the process that led to the proposed name change. She noted Joseph L. Meek was an outstanding Oregon pioneer who brought the Northwest Territories into the United States and helped to develop the Oregon constitution.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards invited Dennis and Virginia Howarth, Co-Chairs of the Concordia Neighborhood Association, to come forward to address the Board.

Mr. Howarth stated they, along with Queenie Samuel of the Concordia Neighborhood Association, were delighted that the school would retain the name of Joseph L. Meek.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards thanked the Howarths for their support of their neighborhood school.

Co-Chair Poe asked if Joseph Meek was a slave-holder.

Ms. Morrison responded not to her knowledge. She said a teacher researched that issue recently and said Mr. Meek was one of very few white Oregonians who had the full trust of the local Native Americans.

The Board voted unanimously to approve Resolution #3176 (vote: 5-0; Directors Regan and Williams absent; Student Representative Cortez voting yes, unofficial).

Co-Chairs Brim-Edwards and Poe, Superintendent Phillips, and Ms. Morrison signed a copy of the resolution and presented it to Ms. Morrison, along with the signing pen.

3. **CLASSIFIED EMPLOYEE RECOGNITION**

Director Morgan stated November 15-19 was Classified Employees Week. He said Board members that week visited Columbia High School, Foster Middle School, Youngson and the Community Transition Center. He said those sites depend on classified employees for many duties. He noted the burden on classified employees has increased, and added they are the eyes and ears for principals and teachers in our schools.

Frank Klejmont, Director of Security, explained the role of campus monitors in our schools. They stop problems before they happen and go above and beyond the scope of their assigned duties. He said all campus monitors are certified by the state as unarmed security and are trained by the Portland Police Special Reaction Team. He noted further training is conducted each year in areas such as gang recognition, bomb identification and narcotics recognition. Campus monitors from various sites were in attendance, and Mr. Klejmont asked them to introduce themselves.

A.J. Morrison highlighted the outstanding work of four classified employees at Joseph L. Meek Professional Technical High School -- Kathryn Starlyn, Data Clerk; Mary Frances Hill, Educational Assistant; Tammie Gill, Principal's Secretary; and Diane Namba-Welsick, Educational Assistant. She noted the many hours classified staff put in to facilitate the move from the Glenhaven site to the Meek site.

Deborah Berry, Director of the PPS Head Start Program, discussed the positive impact of classified employees on the Head Start program. She introduced Yolanda Flores who advocates for families at James John and Faubion elementary schools.

Ms. Flores shared comments about her experiences working with families in the Head Start program. She explained what her job entails and how the Head Start program helps families, and further shared how the Head Start program positively impacted her as a parent with a child in the program.

Director Morgan thanked everyone for their participation and for showcasing the tremendous work done by the District's classified employees. On behalf of the Board, he especially thanked Kathy

Hornstein, President of the Portland Federation of Teachers and Classified Employees (PFTCE), for all she does for Portland Public Schools' classified employees.

4. **FINANCIAL ACCOUNTABILITY**

Presentation of Annual Audit

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards announced the School District receives a comprehensive financial audit each year. She noted the Board would vote on Resolution 3175, "Acceptance and Approval of the Comprehensive Annual Financial Report, Report to Management, and Reports on Requirements of the Single Audit Act and OMB Circular A-133" as part of the Business Agenda.

Director Wynde, Chair of the Board's Finance, Audit and Operations Committee, introduced Heidi Franklin, Interim Chief Financial Officer, and Parry Ankerson, Pauly, Rogers and Co., P.C.

Ms. Heidi Franklin referenced two reports: "Comprehensive Annual Financial Report for the Year Ended June 30, 2004" and "Report on Requirements of the Single Audit Act and OMB Circular A-133 for the Year Ended June 30, 2004." She noted both reports have been reviewed in great detail by the Finance, Audit and Operations Committee. She noted several items within the District-wide financial statements. She commended the Board for having a reserve at 3%, and suggested she may recommend that the reserve be set at 5%.

Mr. Parry Ankerson referenced the letter to the Board of Education, dated November 19, 2004, from Pauly, Rogers as contained in the Board Book (a copy of this document may be obtained in the Board Support Office). He stated it was his firm's responsibility to audit the financial statements of the School District. Mr. Ankerson said PPS received prestigious awards from several organizations for excellent reporting on the financial statements. He particularly noted Joanne Ossanna, Interim Controller, for her work on the financial statements. On an ongoing basis, Mr. Ankerson said Pauly, Rogers offers the School District advice in dealing with financial issues and noted Portland Public Schools was the largest and most complicated school district in the state.

Director Jackson said he was still interested in having a monthly variance report prepared. He said a report of that type would allow one to look at the need to readjust mid-stream in order to stay within the constraints of the budget.

Ms. Franklin said she would be happy to provide Director Jackson and other Board members with such a report, and said the system in place currently would allow that type of report to be generated rather easily.

Director Wynde said the Finance, Audit and Committee would get that information and report back to the full Board with a recommendation for what might work best.

Director Jackson said he also would like to see the budget in a different format. He referenced a one- to two-page format he prepared and submitted earlier. He stated that format would be more comprehensible for him and others in the community.

Director Wynde noted that the Citizens Budget Report was prepared and widely distributed last year for the first time. He said addressing the need to have an understandable budget was important.

Director Wynde observed that on the financial side, there have been dramatic upgrades to the system in the past two years that should be of great assistance in producing reports such as the one requested by Director Jackson. He said in his professional work as a banker he sees many financial statements, and he emphasized that for an organization the size and complexity of Portland Public Schools, it was a testament to the work of the Finance Department that there is only one item identified within the financial letter. Director Wynde also asked that once the Board passes the resolution approving the audit, that the comprehensive audit be posted on the School District's website.

Co-Chair brim-Edwards asked Mr. Ankerson if he would recommend any further internal or external controls.

Mr. Ankerson responded he did not see where there was a need for PPS to have other controls in place.

Facilities

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards stated that in line with the Board's ongoing efforts to more effectively utilize the School District's facilities to support student learning, the Board would vote on the sales agreement with the City of Portland for the majority of the property on the Washington High School campus. She added the Board would vote on the resolution as part of the Business Agenda later in the evening.

First Reading of Policies

1.40.080-P, Reimbursement of Expenses – Board of Directors: Director Wynde, Chair of the Board's Finance, Audit and Operations Committee, said Board members do not receive money for their work and the proposed policy connects the Board Office budget to the appropriate policies to ensure a high level of accountability. He thanked Heidi Franklin, Interim Chief Financial Officer, for her work with Board leadership in developing the policy and for her work in providing training sessions for Board members on the proposed policy. Director Wynde stated it was the unanimous recommendation of the Community and Staff Relations Committee to move the policy forward for a First Reading.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards stated the policy establishes conditions and parameters of reimbursement for necessary and reasonable expenses incurred by the Portland Public Schools Board of Directors in the conduct of Board business. She said the draft policy may be viewed at http://www.pps.k12.or.us/.docs/pg/5899. The policy contact is Heidi Franklin, P.O. Box 3107, Portland, Oregon 97208-3107. Ms. Franklin's telephone number is 503-916-2000, and her email address is hfranklin@pps.k12.or.us. She noted the last date for comment is January 13, 2005.

Director Morgan noted that the policy would be setting policy for Board members that was in line with policies currently in place for senior management.

5.60.010-P, Administrative Employees' Terms of Employment: Co-Chair Brim Edwards said that over the last three years as a Board member, she has worked to develop terms of employment for senior staff that would prohibit excessive buy-out clauses, use of automobiles, supplemental health insurance policies, etc. She said previously there was not enough support to move a terms of employment contract for senior staff forward. Co-Chair Brim-Edwards said the Board has increased its oversight, and there would no longer be contracts for employment that had the types of provisions that were contained in contracts prior to 2001. She added the efforts to develop new contract language have been enthusiastically supported by Superintendent Phillips, and the Superintendent spent a significant amount of time aligning the draft policy to areas where the District is moving forward. Co-Chair Brim-Edwards emphasized that the draft policy provides uniformity and fairness, and is a good base for future contracts. She further stated the draft policy would provide greater accountability to taxpayers and the broader community.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards stated the draft policy was recommended for a First Reading by the Board's Ad Hoc Personnel Committee, and the policy establishes standards for non-licensed administrative contracts. The draft policy may be viewed at http://www.pps.k12.or.us/.docs/pg/5899. The policy contact is Vicki L. Phillips, P.O. Box 3107, Portland, Oregon 97208-3107. Her telephone number is 503-916-3200, and her email address is vphillips@pps.k12.or.us. She noted the last date for comment is January 13, 2005.

5. **ACADEMIC ACCOUNTABILITY**

Recognition of Schools Achieving "Exceptional" Status on State Report Cards

Director Jackson announced the following schools achieved "Exceptional" status on State Report Cards for 2003-04 and each was recognized and presented with an award by Co-Chairs Brim-Edwards and Poe and Superintendent Phillips:

Ainsworth Elementary – Liz Casson Taylor, Principal
Alameda Elementary – Teri Geist, Principal
Astor Elementary – John Walden, Principal
Bridlemile Elementary – Debi Bradway, Principal
Duniway Elementary – Tou Meksavanh, Principal
Edwards Elementary – Sarah Lewins, Principal
Forest Park Elementary – Kevin Crotchet, Principal
Hollyrood Elementary – Kathryn Anderson, Principal
Laurelhurst Elementary – Tressa Bauer, Principal
Lincoln High School – Peter Hamilton, Principal
Rieke Elementary – Charlene Russell, Principal
Sabin Elementary – Richard Schafer, Principal
Skyline Elementary – Ben Keefer, Principal
Smith Elementary – Jan Smith, Principal
West Sylvan Middle School – Allison Couch, Principal
Winterhaven – Tanya Ghattas, Principal, and Barbara Rudolph, Former Principal
Woodstock Elementary – Mary Patterson

Recognition of Schools that Improved Status on State Report Cards

Suleima Cortez announced the schools that improved their overall ratings on the State Report Cards. Co-Chairs Brim-Edwards and Poe and Superintendent Phillips presented each school with a certificate of achievement. The schools honored were:

Alameda Elementary – Teri Geist, Principal
Clarendon Elementary – Antonio Lopez, Principal
Franklin High School – Charles Hopson, Principal
Grout Elementary – Susan McElroy, Principal
Hayhurst Elementary – Larry Whitson, Principal
Irvington Elementary – Cynthia MacLeod, Principal
James John Elementary – John Ferraro, Principal
Ockley Green Middle School – Joseph Malone, Principal
Portsmouth Middle School – Paul Steger, Principal
Roosevelt High School – CHECK TAPE – Jennifer Fero,
Sabin Elementary – Richard Schafer, Principal
Smith Elementary – Jan Smith, Principal
Whitman Elementary – Lori Clark, Principal
Woodlawn Elementary – Lemil Speed, Principal
Woodmere Elementary – Heather Hull, Principal
Woodstock Elementary – Mary Patterson, Principal

Student Achievement Committee's New Website

Director Jackson, Chair of the Student Achievement Committee, explained the information that is now available on his committee's web page (http://www.pps.k12.or.us/.docs/pg/5869). He stated the web page allows the broader community, staff and others to see the work of the committee, and allows for more transparency regarding the work of that Board committee. He noted, as a Board, it was recognized that not everyone has internet access, and the Community and Staff Relations Committee will come up with a strategy to help share information with everyone in the community.

Director Jackson thanked Joseph Tierney, Compliance Office, who assisted Director Jackson in demonstrating the new committee web page, and for his invaluable assistance in setting up the web page for the committee.

Director Wynde commended Director Jackson for "raising the bar" for other Board committee chairs.

Director Jackson thanked the Information Technology (IT) Department for their ongoing assistance.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards noted it was one more step in Portland Public Schools opening its business up to the broader community. She added that the Board policies were now on the PPS website, rather than just in a large book.

First Reading of Policy

4.10.051-P; Student Enrollment and Transfers Policy: Director Wynde, a member of the Board's Education Options and Professional Development Committee, stated the purpose of the change to the Student Enrollment and Transfers Policy was to clarify the intent of co-enrolled siblings. The change was made in VII.2.c and permits the co-enrolled sibling preference at the high school level.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards noted the draft policy was referred to the full Board for a First Reading by the Education Options and Professional Development Committee. The last day for comment on this policy is January 13, 2005. The policy may be viewed at http://www.pps.k12.or.us/docs/pg/5899. The contact person for the policy is Dr. Maxine Kilcrease, P.O. Box 3107, Portland, OR 97208-3107; telephone 503-916-3170; email mkilcrease@psp.k12.or.us.

Review of State Report Cards Results

Superintendent Phillips noted there are many ways to judge a school's effectiveness, and the State Report Cards are just one of those ways. She added it is one more tool that shows how schools can be viewed. The Superintendent stated there were still challenges ahead for Portland Public Schools.

6. **REPORT FROM MULTNOMAH EDUCATION SERVICE DISTRICT**

Director Wynde introduced Dr. Ed Schmitt, Superintendent of Multnomah Education Service District (MESD). Dr. Schmitt introduced MESD Board members Geri Washington, Chair, and Janice Gratton, Vice Chair. Ms. Washington and Ms. Gratton shared greetings and comments to the Board from the MESD Board of Directors.

Dr. Schmitt highlighted areas of the MESD Annual Report 2003-04. The MESD Annual Report for 2003-04 may be viewed in its entirety at:

www.mesd.k12.or.us/pa/0304annualrep.htm

Dr. Schmitt provided a brief overview of services the MESD provides to Portland Public Schools' students. He noted PPS represents more than half of the students in Multnomah County. School districts can pick and choose services they want from a menu of services offered by the MESD. That list includes school health services and classes for functional living skills for special education students. Dr. Schmitt noted the MESD

provides $20 million in services and programs to Portland Public Schools, and added the MESD and PPS were an excellent model of working together.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards thanked Dr. Schmitt and MESD Board members for the work they do for schools, students and staff.

Dr. Schmitt added the MESD Foundation provides opportunities for students such as the Academic All Stars.

7. STUDENT REPRESENTATIVE'S REPORT

Student Representative Suleima Cortez said SuperSAC students recently met with Frank Klejmont, Director of Security, regarding security concerns in schools. They also discussed getting together with English as a Second Language (ESL) students and including them in leadership activities. She said there are students who have exited the ESL program, and they would like to see them come back as interpreters for various school events. She discussed several other upcoming topics for SuperSAC. She said she is also working on a student leadership retreat, such as the one organized by previous Student Representative to the Board Johnell Bell.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards noted that Josie Hashemian in the Board Office suggested having high school students present at Board meetings regarding what is happening in their respective high schools. She suggested that Ms. Cortez discuss this possibility with the Community and Staff Relations Committee, of which she is now a member.

8. BUSINESS AGENDA

Director Wynde had a question regarding an item as contained in Resolution 3174, "Expenditure Contracts that Exceed $25,000 Limit for Delegation of Authority." He noted the contractor as Northwest Home Care, and the expenditure was for $55,000 for nursing services for one student. He asked for clarity regarding what additional expenses were incurred by this student and what funding and reimbursement PPS received from the state or other sources.

Dr. Maxine Kilcrease, Assistant to the Superintendent, responded she researched that particular issue. She said the total cost per year for that student was $94,477, and the student was a Parkrose School District student, and Parkrose reimburses PPS for the total cost.

Director Wynde further noted within Resolution 3174, an expenditure for Pinnacle Risk Management Services. He said the cost of $91,430 will outsource the administration of Workers Compensation claims, and Pinnacle Risk Management Services was selected to provide that service. He said the District would get better service on Workers Compensation claims as this firm has expertise with this type of activity. He further indicated the School District would experience lower claim costs in this area. He said an expected savings for next year was estimated at between $40,000-$50,000. Director Wynde said the District's Risk Manager noted last year's claims were approximately $500,000, and it was expected the savings would be 10% of that amount.

The Board unanimously approved the remaining items of the Business Agenda (vote: 5-0; Directors Regan and Williams absent; Student Representative Cortez voting yes, unofficial).

9. OTHER BUSINESS

Co-Chair Poe stated he was informed that Portland Public Schools did not have an affirmative action plan in place. He noted that Director Jackson informed him there was an affirmative action plan in place. He asked the Superintendent for clarification, and added that the issue has been a topic of ongoing discussion within the community.

Superintendent Phillips responded that the information she obtained from the Human Resources Department indicated there was an affirmative action plan in place up until the mid '80's. She said PPS did not currently have a formal plan in place, but did have a set of principles, and there are discussions taking place on how to put those principles into a very aggressive recruitment plan.

Director Jackson said the information he shared with the Board was regarding an ORS that was passed when Neil Goldschmidt was governor, and it required all school districts in Oregon to employ administrators and educators in a proportion equal to the population they served. He added the state had until 1997 to come into compliance. He said PPS did not have an affirmative action plan per se, and the District needed to become more aware of the law and find ways to come into compliance.

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards asked General Counsel to provide the Board with the statute referenced by Director Jackson and further provide the Board with her interpretation of the statute and have an overlay from Human Resources on how PPS is doing in terms of compliance.

Director Wynde added that regardless of formal legal obligation, he would support the view that it was incumbent upon the School District in short order to develop a clearly articulated set of principles and practices targeted towards serious efforts so the staff of Portland Public Schools reflects the population of the District.

Co-Chair Poe said he strongly concurred, and he encouraged a very aggressive recruitment strategy for employing and retaining persons of color in the School District. He added PPS was one of the rare institutions in the area that did not have an affirmative action plan in place.

10. REMAINING CITIZEN COMMENT

There was no remaining citizen comment.

11. ADJOURN

Co-Chair Brim-Edwards announced the next regular meeting of the Board of Education will be held at on Monday, January 10, 2005, at 6:30 PM at the Blanchard Education Service Center.

The regular meeting of the Board of Education for December 13, 2004 adjourned at 9:25 PM at the call of Co-Chair Julia Brim-Edwards.

Submitted by:

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Julie Joel, Executive Assistant
PPS Board of Education